BUILDER, STEP 20

Opus 5.5 missed our count.
A cheap model hit it.

The model was not the problem. Our ask was.

THE FIRST ASK

One line, two readings.

STEP 11, THE TASK

"Count every client and every route, and rank by the size of the change, up or down."

```
# our count: each route on its own
route BE-BE: 25 -> 60 (+35)

# Opus 5.5: client and route pairs
Alpha Retail (example), BE-NL: 33 -> 0 (-33)
```

Pi and Claude Code, 2 runs per setup, the same made-up data.

THE FIRST ASK, THE RESULT

2 of 8 matched the count.

	MATCHED	COST PER RUN
Pi, DeepSeek V4.1 Flash	2 of 2	under 1 cent
Pi, Qwen 3.8 Flash	0 of 2	under 2 cents
Claude Code, Opus 5.5	0 of 2	35 and 36 cents, as shown
Opus plans, DeepSeek builds	0 of 2	31 cents, as shown

The step 19 test went red on all 8. It also pins the format of each line.

THE SHARPER ASK

We added two sentences.

FIRST

"Count each client on its own and each route on its own, not client and route pairs."

SECOND

"Print one header line, then the three changes, each line in exactly this format:

```
1. route  AA-BB    10 ->   20  +10"
```

The same task, models and starting commit as before.

THE SHARPER ASK, THE RESULT

8 of 8 matched the count.

	MATCHED	STEP 19 TEST
Pi, DeepSeek V4.1 Flash	2 of 2	2 of 2
Pi, Qwen 3.8 Flash	2 of 2	1 of 2
Claude Code, Opus 5.5	2 of 2	2 of 2
Opus plans, DeepSeek builds	2 of 2	2 of 2

The one red test had the right numbers and different spacing. The 16 runs in our tables each took under 4 minutes.

BEFORE YOU INSTALL

Pi does not stop to ask.

- → Pi's README: "Pi does not include a built-in permission system".
- → It runs with your permissions. It can run any command that you can run.
- → We ran it in a macOS sandbox, on a copy, with made-up data. Use a new folder. Keep your real work and keys out of it.

WHAT THIS DOES NOT SHOW

Two runs. One small task.

- → It does not rank these models.
- → Cost as shown is the figure Claude Code reports. We ran it signed in with a plan, so it is not a bill we paid.
- → We did not check each model provider's data policy. So made-up data only.

FREE FILES

Get the files. Free.

→ The sharper ask

→ Every result, per setup

→ The steps to try Pi, with the test as your check

On my profile, under Featured: AI Starter Kit, step 20. Save this post.

Next: the Expert level starts with guardrails.